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# Fernando Hoces de la Guardia

📍 Berkeley, CA (open to Bay Area)

## Summary

Policy researcher and applied economist who has led teams through complex data analyses that inform major policy decisions, from national policy at government agencies in Chile to multi-year research programs at UC Berkeley. Designed and implemented a randomized experiment inside a complex data project with many moving pieces: multi-source data ingestion, record linkage across registries and journals, hypothesis-encoding protocols, and a team of research assistants. Carried out quasi-experimental impact evaluations (difference-in-differences, regression discontinuity, instrumental variables) on large administrative datasets. A career in research transparency and reproducibility highlights a dedication to rigorous, clearly interpretable data outputs that translate into actionable recommendations.

## Technical Skills

Programming R (expert), Stata,  $\text{\LaTeX}$ , Python, SQL

Data & AI tooling Git / GitHub, RMarkdown / Quarto, Jupyter, reproducible data pipelines, record linkage across large administrative datasets, LLM-assisted automation (agentic coding tools, e.g. Claude Code)

Methods Causal inference, experiments, difference-in-differences, regression discontinuity, instrumental variables, survey design, cost-benefit analysis, microsimulation

Languages Spanish (native), English (fluent)

## Selected Technical Projects

Data pipeline Built and maintained a data pipeline over 5,000+ pre-registered hypotheses pulled from multiple study registries: automated ingestion, record linkage across registries and journals, and reproducible analysis datasets. [Working paper](#).

Reproduction platform Co-designed and oversaw the Social Science Reproduction Platform, which hosted 300+ reproductions (200+ papers, 500+ claims). [ACRE guide](#) [\[archive\]](#)

Shiny apps for policy analysis Built interactive Shiny apps letting readers test how a policy estimate changes under different modeling assumptions, applied to [mass deworming](#), [progressive wealth taxation](#), and [minimum wage](#) policy estimates (underlined links open the live apps).

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## Experience

- 2019–2026 **Assistant Project Scientist**, UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, BERKELEY
- **Co-PI, Publication Bias and Standardization of Results research program:** secured \$880K (FAIR/NHH) to measure and explain under-reporting of results in economics. Designed and ran a randomized experiment with a sample of over 300 teams of academic researchers; built a hypothesis-encoding protocol and led a team of 3 research assistants.
  - **Open Policy Analysis Initiative (BITSS):** led program embedding open-science methods into government policy analysis. Presented the framework and delivered tailored recommendations to agencies including CBO, IADB, USAID, and Chile's Ministry of Finance. Framework published in *Science & Public Policy*. [bitss.org/opa/](https://bitss.org/opa/)
  - **Interactive policy-analysis apps:** built Shiny apps letting users test how policy estimates change under alternative assumptions (mass deworming, wealth taxation, minimum wage).
  - **Social Science Reproduction Platform:** co-designed and oversaw a platform that hosted 300+ reproductions by researchers worldwide (200+ papers, 500+ claims).
- 2017–2018 **Postdoctoral Research Fellow**, UC BERKELEY (BITSS)
- Designed and delivered training curriculum (Git/GitHub, pre-registration, dynamic documents, reproducibility) for hundreds of researchers across multiple countries.
  - Co-authored an IDB report on reproducible research, adopted as staff guidance.
- 2011–2012 **Junior Economic Advisor**, MINISTRY OF FINANCE, CHILE
- Produced time-sensitive analyses on labor, social, and education policy for the Minister's office; quantified budget impact of policies informing multi-billion-dollar allocations.
- 2010–2011 **Research Associate**, UNIVERSIDAD DE CHILE, DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMICS
- Evaluated a national financial aid program using Regression Discontinuity on administrative records; found small effects on enrollment and graduation, informing follow-up programs.
- 2006–2008 **Economist**, MINISTRY OF PLANNING, CHILE
- Co-led impact evaluation of *Chile Solidario*, the national anti-poverty program, using Difference-in-Differences and matching on administrative + survey data.
  - Produced official poverty and inequality estimates (pre- and post-transfer).

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## Education

- 2017 **PhD, Public Policy Analysis**, Pardee RAND Graduate School, Santa Monica, CA
- 2010 **M.A., Economics**, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA
- 2006 **B.A. & M.A., Economics**, Universidad de Chile, Santiago, Chile

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## Selected Publications

- 2026 *Hoces de la Guardia, F.*, Miguel, E., et al. "Beyond Publication Bias: Characterizing and Understanding Missing Results in Economics." [Latest draft](#).
- 2026 Brodeur, A., . . . , *Hoces de la Guardia, F.*, et al. "Reproducibility and robustness of economics and political science research." *Nature* 652, 151–156.
- 2021 *Hoces de la Guardia, F.*, Grant, S., Miguel, E. "A Framework for Open Policy Analysis." *Science & Public Policy*. Full list on [personal site](#).

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## Teaching

- 2019–2022 UC Berkeley: [Introduction to Econometrics](#); Environmental Economics & Policy
- 2007–2010 Econometrics I, Universidad de Chile (3 terms)